

**SERBIA**

**Capital city:** Belgrade  
**Area:** 29,913 sq miles (77,474 sq km)  
**Population:** 10,000,000  
**Official language:** Serbian  
**Major religions:** Christian 92%, Muslim 3%, other 5%  
**Government:** Republic  
**Currency:** Dinar  
**Adult literacy rate:** 98%  
**Life expectancy:** 73 years  
**People per doctor:** 476

**MONTENEGRO**

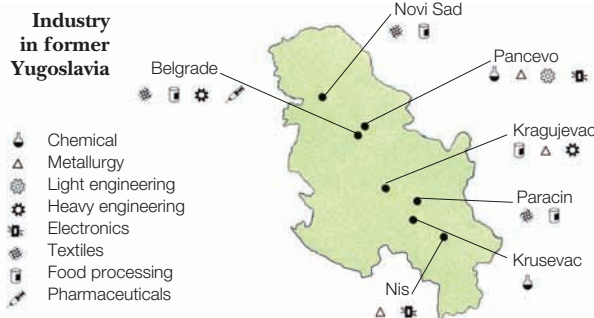
**Capital city:** Podgorica  
**Area:** 5,415 sq miles (14,026 sq km)  
**Population:** 678,000  
**Official language:** Montenegrin  
**Major religions:** Christian 78%, Muslim 18%, other 4%  
**Government:** Republic  
**Currency:** Euro  
**Adult literacy rate:** 98%

**BOSNIA AND HERZEGOVINA**

**Capital city:** Sarajevo  
**Area:** 19,741 sq miles (51,130 sq km)  
**Population:** 4,200,000  
**Official language:** Bosnian, Serbian, Croatian  
**Major religions:** Christian 50%, Muslim 40%, other 10%  
**Government:** Multiparty democracy

# SERBIA

SINCE THE BREAKUP OF THE FORMER YUGOSLAVIA in 1991, Serbia embarked on an extreme nationalistic course by supporting local Serbs in the Bosnian War of 1992–5 and in Kosovo in 1998–9, leading to international intervention to bring peace to the region. The country is now trying to repair the economic and structural damage caused by the conflicts, and was declared a republic in 2006.

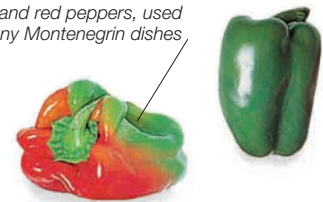
**PEOPLE**

There is a variety of languages spoken in the former united territory of Serbia and Montenegro. Serbs and Montenegrins speak a similar language and write in the Cyrillic script as used in Russian. The Hungarian and Albanian minorities use the Latin alphabet, as used in English, and speak separate, unrelated languages. Voting papers, being handed in here, are printed in all languages.

# MONTENEGRO

WHEN THE FORMER YUGOSLAVIA broke up in 1991, Serbia and Montenegro emerged from the wreckage as a joint republic, dominated by Serbia. Montenegro finally became a separate nation in 2006, after its people voted to split from Serbia. Since then, it has become a member of the United Nations, and is seeking membership of the European Union.

Green and red peppers, used in many Montenegrin dishes

**CUISINE**

A wide variety of tasty dishes are eaten in Montenegro. The country's cuisine has an Italian twist, with meatballs, stuffed peppers, cheese, wine, and bread all featuring heavily on Montenegrin menus.

# BOSNIA AND HERZEGOVINA

BOSNIA AND HERZEGOVINA declared independence in 1992. For centuries, the area contained a mixture of Muslim Bosnians, Catholic Croats, and Orthodox Serbs. After independence, civil war broke out and many thousands of people were killed on all sides. The war ended in 1995 and the country was split into two separate halves—a Serb republic and a Muslim-Croat federation.

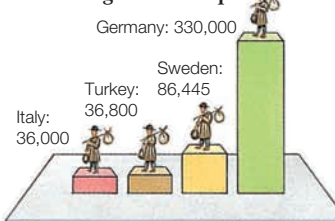
**ETHNIC CLEANSING**  
 Serbs fighting in Bosnia undertook a policy of ethnic cleansing. This involved removing, or "cleansing", Muslims and Croats from areas they inhabited alongside Serbs. Thousands of non-Serbs were murdered. Others were frightened into leaving their homes and seeking safety in more welcoming countries.



Muslim girls and women traditionally wear a headscarf to cover their hair.

**CITY OF SARAJEVO**

By 1990, the ancient town of Sarajevo had grown into a large, modern city. But war exposed the city to Serb gunfire from the surrounding hills, and many citizens were killed. Those that remained led a primitive existence, often with no food, heat, or proper housing.

**Bosnian refugees in Europe****Find out more**

**BREAKUP OF YUGOSLAVIA:**  
 81, 124  
**RELIGIONS:** 274–275  
**DANUBE RIVER:** 79